A+MENTOR

Jammu & Kashmir General Knowledge

Regional GK starter notes | JKSSB • J&K recruitment • State PCS

How to use these notes

Read the key points, recall the facts without looking, and attempt the practice questions at the end. These are starter notes, not a substitute for the complete syllabus.

1. Jammu & Kashmir: Geography

• The Union Territory of Jammu and Kashmir and the Union Territory of Ladakh are separate administrative units. Do not confuse their current boundaries or capitals/administrative arrangements in exam questions.

• Jammu, the Kashmir Valley and the Pir Panjal region have distinct relief, climate and settlement patterns. The Himalayas influence rainfall, river systems, transport and biodiversity.

• Important river systems include the Jhelum, Chenab, Ravi and Tawi, along with their tributaries. Learn each river's broad course and associated districts from an up-to-date map.

• Dal Lake and Wular Lake are among the well-known lakes of the Kashmir Valley. Lake conditions and environmental issues are dynamic and should be studied from current sources.

2. Economy, Agriculture and Resources

• Agriculture and horticulture are important to the regional economy. Apples, walnuts, almonds, saffron and other horticultural products are associated with different areas; production and rankings vary by year.

• Tourism, handicrafts, handloom, horticulture, services and small industries contribute to livelihoods. Examples of crafts include Pashmina shawls, carpets, papier-mâché and wood carving.

• Revise hydroelectric projects, transport links, tunnels, national highways and railway developments using current official sources, because projects and operating status change.

3. Culture and Heritage

• Jammu and Kashmir have diverse linguistic, religious, artistic and culinary traditions. Avoid reducing the region to a single culture or language.

• Languages used in the region include Kashmiri, Dogri, Urdu, Hindi, Gojri, Pahari and others. The Eighth Schedule of the Constitution includes Dogri, Kashmiri and Urdu is also an official language of the UT under its law; check the latest legal framework for precise questions.

• Important cultural topics include Sufi and Rishi traditions, shrines, temples, monasteries in the wider Himalayan region, folk music, crafts, festivals and regional cuisines.

4. Polity and Administration

• The Jammu and Kashmir Reorganisation Act, 2019 reorganised the former state into the Union Territories of Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh, effective 31 October 2019.

• Article 370 and related constitutional developments are important constitutional topics. Study the legal text, Supreme Court judgment and official parliamentary records rather than relying on short social-media summaries.

• Current officeholders, administrative divisions, districts, schemes, recruitment rules and budget figures change. Verify these through official government portals close to the examination.

5. History: Revision Themes

• Study ancient and medieval sites, regional dynasties, cultural exchanges and trade routes in the Himalayan region using authoritative sources.

• Modern history themes include Dogra rule, political and social developments before 1947, the events surrounding accession, post-independence constitutional developments and the 2019 reorganisation.

• Separate established facts from contested political narratives. In exam answers, use neutral language and identify the source or date when a fact is time-sensitive.

6. JKSSB/State PCS Preparation Checklist

• Make a district-wise map sheet: district headquarters, rivers, lakes, mountain passes, parks, pilgrimage/tourism sites and major infrastructure.

• Prepare short notes for geography, history, culture, economy, polity, environment, current affairs and government schemes.

• Use official JKSSB recruitment notifications for syllabus, exam pattern, eligibility, dates and corrigenda. Do not rely on old screenshots or unofficial claims.

• Create a current-affairs log with date, event, department, scheme objective, beneficiaries and one exam-relevant fact.

Practice Questions

1. Since 31 October 2019, Jammu and Kashmir has been a:

A. State with Ladakh as a district

B. Union Territory

C. Country

D. Division of Punjab

Answer: B — Union Territory
Explanation: The 2019 reorganisation created the UT of Jammu and Kashmir and the separate UT of Ladakh.

2. Which lake is in the Kashmir Valley?

A. Dal Lake

B. Chilika Lake

C. Sambhar Lake

D. Loktak Lake

Answer: A — Dal Lake
Explanation: Dal Lake is a well-known lake in Srinagar.

3. Which crop is strongly associated with Pampore and parts of Kashmir?

A. Saffron

B. Tea

C. Rubber

D. Jute

Answer: A — Saffron
Explanation: Pampore is widely known for saffron cultivation.

4. Which law is central to the 2019 reorganisation?

A. Government of India Act 1935

B. Jammu and Kashmir Reorganisation Act, 2019

C. Indian Councils Act 1909

D. Regulating Act 1773

Answer: B — Jammu and Kashmir Reorganisation Act, 2019
Explanation: The 2019 Act provided for the reorganisation into two Union Territories.

5. Which craft is associated with Kashmir?

A. Papier-mâché

B. Blue pottery of Jaipur only

C. Kanchipuram silk only

D. Bidriware only

Answer: A — Papier-mâché
Explanation: Papier-mâché is among the region's recognised crafts.

6. For the latest JKSSB exam syllabus, the best source is:

A. An undated social post

B. An old coaching poster

C. Official JKSSB notification

D. A random message forward

Answer: C — Official JKSSB notification
Explanation: The official notification and any corrigenda control the current requirements.

Prepared by A+Mentor for learning and revision. Check official notifications and textbooks for the latest syllabus and facts.